



Trending topics on twitter aren't an accident, but thanks to large online groups conversing

conferences in addition to online discussion forum for interaction with community members who don't have time to participate in meetings. As of the time of this writing, there are around 264 [active .NET](#) groups around the world with groups in Bangalore, Chennai, Pune, Delhi and Trivandrum. A search on meetup.com with the [keyword .NET](#) returns several results of [various .NET](#) groups.

Pros - Easy to use, Support options, Possible to find other groups and establish connections, Direct interaction possible (in case of offline groups)

Cons - Fear of closure, Migration problems, Limited resources and customization possibility, Travelling difficulties

Creating Your Own Self Hosted Group/Forum

Once upon a time, Microsoft had several newsgroups related to Internet browsers, Internet servers, Web content development, Programming, Languages, Databases and Security. However, Microsoft has already migrated most of their newsgroups to the popular web based MSDN forums which enable community members to interact effectively.

Discussion forums are web based groups formed to provide help and assistance for a wide range of topics. As of today, there are several forums available for all major topic areas as listed below

You can easily create and establish forums similar to above mentioned links with the help of several web based discussion forum software scripts such as phpBB, vBulletin and DotNetNuke. In order to create and activate your group with the self-hosted software, you need to purchase a domain name, shared hosting space (Linux or Windows) from a web hosting provider and install the required script from with the Softaculous module in CPanel.